MOST IMPROVED COLLEGE*
Department of Media and Communication Studies, Savitribai Phule Pune University
Pune

The Newsroom Nursery

With industry-led curriculum updates, DMCS is redefining media education for the digital communications era

By **DHAVAL S. KULKARNI**



The Department of Media and Communication Studies (DMCS) at Savitribai Phule Pune University was founded on a remarkably prescient idea. In 1990, when television was still emerging as a major force in India, Prof. E.V. Chitnis—the space scientist who helped establish ISRO and later chaired the Press Trust of India—recognised the potential of electronic media after a visit to the US. At the time, the university's well-known Ranade Institute was the primary destination for journalism education in the region. Chitnis pushed for a separate department focused on the emerging world of electronic media, laying the foundation for what would become DMCS.

More than three decades later, the department continues to evolve alongside the industry it was created to serve. Its flagship MSc programme in Media and Communication Studies admits 50 students annually and offers specialisations in media research and media production. The research stream spans areas such as corporate communication, brand management and public relations. The department also runs a postgraduate diploma in Indian Film Studies and has around 14 doctoral scholars. According to Dr Madhavi Reddy, head of the department, its classrooms bring together students from diverse academic backgrounds, including international enrolments. Its growing stature is reflected in the rankings, where it has climbed from No. 4 in 2022 to No. 2 in 2026, making it the most improved college in its category.

What has driven the department's recent rise is its focus on industry relevance. Reddy says feedback from alumni working across media and entertainment has prompted a stronger emphasis on areas such as scriptwriting and instructional design. Scriptwriting credits have been increased to meet growing demand from OTT platforms, while instructional design, which covers

TOP 5 MOST IMPROVED COLLEGES — MASS COMM.

RANK	COLLEGE	CITY	RANK 2026	RANK 2022
1	DEPARTMENT OF MEDIA AND COMMUNICATION STUDIES, SAVITRIBAI PHULE PUNE UNIVERSITY	Pune	2	4
2	MANIPAL INSTITUTE OF COMMUNICATION, MAHE	Manipal	3	5
3	KRISTU JAYANTI (DEEMED TO BE UNIVERSITY)	Bengaluru	22	33
4	AMITY SCHOOL OF COMMUNICATION, NOIDA	Noida	8	11
5	SCHOOL OF MEDIA AND COMMUNICATION STUDIES, GALGOTIAS UNIVERSITY	Greater Noida	17	22